

WHAT IS IMAGINATION?

Part of the way we think is to form images or ideas in our minds of things and situations that are not physically present or happening, based on knowledge that we have stored in our memory. Some people are better than others at creative imagination—that is, changing or manipulating their mental images to create new ideas. Give it a try . . . Imagination has no limits.

BRAIN BOX

It takes imagination to solve problems and puzzles. First, you mull over what has to be done, scroll through the various solutions in your head, discard the ideas that will not work, test a few of the ones that might, then—hey presto!—you’ve invented the wheel. Just imagine the possibilities . . .



TASTE TEST

Imagine yourself sinking your teeth into your favorite cake or munching on some salty fries. The mental taste is so strong and enticing that your mouth begins to water in anticipation. We use our “sense memories” to summon up smells, too, so don’t think of anything that smells disgusting!

TELLING STORIES

When we remember the past or dream about the future, we’re telling ourselves stories inside our heads. Creative writers turn these stories into works of fiction, using their vivid powers of imagination to conjure up interesting characters, exciting plots, and colorful twists.

BIG IMAGINATION



BRAIN BOGLERS

The prefrontal cortex of the brain is the key to our imagination. Located at the very front of the brain, just behind the forehead, the prefrontal cortex is fed information from other parts of the brain. It is where we make plans and decisions, arrange and organize our thoughts, and have our smartest ideas.

